

I RIDE FOR THEM

Written by

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A Graphic Novel
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CHAPTER 1

PAGE 3 (FIVE PANELS) (BLACK AND WHITE)

1. INT. HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of a WOMAN screaming. She's in agony. Sweating profusely.

2. INT. HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

This is a modest home, middle-class in nature, tidy. A painting of Buckingham Palace on the wall.

The screaming Woman is on the floor in a white nightgown. She is pregnant and in labor. Her HUSBAND is at the receiving end, eying where the baby will come out. He has a look of extreme worry. Because behind him; there is an entire team of menacing looking POLICE OFFICERS (futuristic, helmets). They have their handcuffs at the ready, waiting.

CAPTION

London, England. The Year 2052.

HUSBAND

Honey, you must stop pushing, please.

WOMAN

Fuck you! And if you're not going to help, get outta the way.

3. INT. HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Full body profile shot of the baby - (baby has just come out, lying on the floor, crying)

4. INT. HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

The Husband is aggressively led out of the house in handcuffs (cuffed behind his back).

HUSBAND

I told her to stop. She wouldn't listen!

5. INT. HOUSE - LIVING RM - NIGHT

The baby is being taken by an officer. The Woman is reaching out for the baby as a handcuff is slapped onto the Woman's wrist.

WOMAN

Let me hold him. Please...

PAGE 4,5 (DOUBLE SPLASH - BLACK AND WHITE)

1. EXT. COMMUTER TRAIN TERMINAL - DAY

Wide shot - With the Big Ben clock in the distance, what looks like thousands of people from all walks, wait for a commuter train to arrive. They're packed together tighter than sardines.

2. EXT. TRAIN TERMINAL - DAY

AVA CAMPBELL, Black (30s), brilliant but the world doesn't know it yet, pushes her way through the crowd and into the train; wearing a business suit a size too big. She's had a rough day. Backpack on her back, big enough for a laptop. She squeezes past an attractive woman.

AVA

(to woman as she enters
train)

You're not as skinny as you think.
Make room.

3. INT. TRAIN - DAY

Ava is on the train, standing amongst the despondent crowd of people. An OLD MAN nearby is reading a newspaper.

4. INT. TRAIN - DAY. THE NEWSPAPER (FULL FRAME/PANEL)

The headline on the paper reads: "Childbirth Remains Illegal,
No End in Sight"

5. EXT. LONDON - DAY

Wide shot - The same commuter train, traveling through the city. It passes by a large digital billboard that reads:
"World Population - 13 billion"

PAGE 6 (FOUR PANELS)

1. EXT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT - ESTABLISHING - NIGHT

Wide shot. Upscale, downtown London in the distance.

CAPTION

Ava and her boyfriend's uptown
apartment.

2. INT. APARTMENT UNIT - NIGHT

Large windows with a view to downtown London. But it's messy
as hell; beer cans scattered about, dirty clothes.

-- Ava has just entered, coming home to DAN, her boyfriend.
He is a total slob, drinking a beer and watching TV on the
couch.

DAN

You're late, Ava. And by the way,
my beer's empty.

AVA

So is my pocketbook. I need a new
hard drive.

DAN

First things first.

3. INT. APARTMENT UNIT - NIGHT

Ava is shaking up a can of beer with a vindictive look on her
face. The open refrigerator is behind her; just beer, AND
milk.

4. INT. APARTMENT UNIT - NIGHT

Ava is giving Dan the beer. At the same time, he gives her a
wad of cash. They exchange.

DAN

Took long enough.

AVA
Long enough? Wish I could say the
same about your knob. Where's the
baby?

DAN
Same place you left her.

PAGE 7 (THREE PANELS)

1. INT. APARTMENT UNIT - OFFICE - NIGHT

This is a home office with a massive computer terminal,
multiple monitors. It's impressive by average consumer
standards. But much of the equipment has been piecemealed
together. A baby crib is set in the corner.

Ava has just entered. Outside of the room we hear/see Dan
react to his exploding beer.

SFX
(beer exploding)
Whoosh!

DAN
(out of frame)
Bitch!

2. INT. APARTMENT UNIT - OFFICE - NIGHT

Ava peers over the baby crib, smiling.

AVA
(to baby)
Did you miss mummy?

3. INT. APARTMENT UNIT - OFFICE - NIGHT

Ava is at her computer terminal, chugs pills from a
prescription bottle. The baby crib in the b.g.

There is also a small Cactus plant in the background.

AVA (THOUGHT BUBBLE)
Those fuckers don't know their ass
from their ears. I'll create
something that blows their minds.
Then they'll have to give me that
contract.

PAGE 8 (FIVE PANELS) (BLACK AND WHITE)**1. EXT. PALACE OF WESTMINSTER - ESTABLISHING - DAY**

Looks just like it does today in 2022. Media drones flying overhead. Thousands of protesters shouting, and holding up picket signs. Mostly women.

Signs read: "Procreation Over Population" - "Dirty Diapers Are a Right" - "These Boobs Were Made For Nursing"

One FEMALE PROTESTER is yelling, flipping off the palace with her middle finger.

CAPTION

Three weeks later...

PROTESTER

(middle finger up)

My reaction to no contractions!

2. INT. PALACE OF WESTMINSTER - AUDITORIUM - DAY

Ava is dressed in another business suit, speaking behind a podium on stage to a distinguished audience (men, women, people in power). They look unimpressed with her pitch.

CAPTION

New Parliament - Overpopulation
Committee Meeting.

AVA

I'm talking about recreating the
childbirth experience.

WOMAN IN AUDIENCE

Rubbish...

MAN IN AUDIENCE

Impossible...

RANDOM AUDIENCE MEMBER

Pure madness...

3. INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY

Medium shot on Ava as she is addressing the audience. A name sticker on her jacket reads: "Ava Campbell, Software Engineer"

AVA
I have engineered the software.
It's completely automated. No
maintenance required. And to access
it, all you need is this.

4. INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY

Extreme close-up of microchip Ava is holding up to the audience. The micro-chip is the size of a nickel, unimpressive.

5. INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY

Over-the-shoulder shot via Ava - Ava speaking from the podium. A YOUNG COUPLE is sitting on a couch, center stage (casual clothing). Their eyes are closed, and they are holding hands.

A computerized-looking photo of Joy should be on the monitor/screen in the background.

AVA
With their subconscious and this
microchip working in tandem, our
test couple is currently in a
virtual world. A paradise. I call
it The Birthplace.

PAGE 9 (TWO PANELS)

1. INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY

Close-up. The couple is on the couch. Their eyes are now open; they gaze into each other's eyes like they just had the best experience of their lives.

2. INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY

Wider shot. As the couple holds hands, the micro-chip is slightly visible underneath the skin on their wrists. The woman is holding her belly (as if she is pregnant, but she is not).

Ava is standing near them.

AVA
Please share your experience with
our audience.

WOMAN

We had a baby boy. He was so real.
The contractions were painful yet
welcomed.

MAN

There was a woman there... coaching
us.

PAGE 10 (TWO PANELS)

**1. EXT. PARADISE - DAY (THE VIRTUAL WORLD CALLED "THE
BIRTHPLACE") (COLOR)**

It resembles the Garden of Eden - trees, flowers, straw
fields, flowing rivers.

The same couple is laying in the middle of a field, wearing
loin cloth. The woman is in the labor position, sweating,
pushing, now noticeably pregnant. The man is beside her,
holding her hand.

We see another woman (JOY), from behind, kneeling in front of
the pregnant woman. Joy is wearing scrubs with a futuristic
flair, latex gloves, and a futuristic wrist watch that
doubles as a program downloader.

CAPTION

The virtual world... aka, The
Birthplace.

NOTE: All panels in the Birthplace are in color. All panels
in the real world are black and white.

2. INT. AUDITORIUM - DAY (REAL WORLD)

Ava is still addressing the audience (a profile shot in a
smaller panel might work for this).

CAPTION

New Parliament - Overpopulation
Committee Meeting.

AVA

That woman was a midwife? Her name
is... is... we'll call her, Joy.
She helps with every delivery.
Customers receive instant
conception after sex, and nine
minutes of bonding. Then your
experience there ends.

(MORE)

AVA (CONT'D)

And the child is pleasantly, and
immediately cleared from the
program's memory.

PAGE 11 (TWO PANELS)

1. EXT. PARADISE - DAY

Joy gives the baby to the couple.

JOY

Here's your baby.

2. EXT. PARADISE - DAY

Joy is watching the couple in delight.

JOY

Not everyone gets a moment like
this. Don't take it for granted.

PAGE 12 (FIVE PANELS)

1. EXT. COTTAGE - DUSK (ESTABLISHING)

The charming, immaculate cottage is sitting in the middle of
a manicured rainforest. Waterfalls, walking paths.

CAPTION

Joy's cottage in The Birthplace...

2. INT. COTTAGE - NIGHT

Minimal furniture. Very neat. Windows with a beautiful view.
Stacks of towels, folded scrubs, boxes of latex gloves piled
in the corner. Joy sits at the kitchen table, looking at her
high-tech watch. It has a touchscreen on it.

JOY

(Thought Bubble)

This place needs some life.

JOY (CONT'D)

(into her watch)

Download Cactus plant.

3. INT. COTTAGE - NIGHT

Like a 3d printer that moves at the speed of light, a small cactus plant has fizzled into existence onto the windowsill.

4. INT. COTTAGE - NIGHT

Joy is touching the cactus on the windowsill. Her finger is getting pricked by one of the spines. Blood is visible on her finger (THE COLOR BLUE).

JOY
You don't know if you want to be
mean or nice. Or maybe you're good
at both.

5. INT. COTTAGE - NIGHT

Joy has fallen asleep at the table. Cactus in the windowsill in the background.

PAGE 13 (FOUR PANELS)

1. INT. COMPUTER MAINFRAME/SERVER RM. - NIGHT

Close up of computer keyboard and screen; massive servers in the background. Hands typing on keyboard (gloves on). We don't know who is typing. On the computer screen it reads:
VIRUS UPLOADING...

CAPTION
The Birthplace Server Room... In
real world London.

2. INT. COTTAGE - DAY

Joy has abruptly woken up.

CAPTION
Something woke Joy out of her
sleep. A gut feeling that things
were different.

3. INT. COTTAGE - DAY

Joy is looking out the window. In shock.

JOY
(Thought Bubble)
I must be having a nightmare.

4. EXT. JOY'S COTTAGE - DAY

WIDE SHOT - Joy's cottage is now sitting in the middle of an urban hell. Decrepit high-rise buildings, liquor stores, dark alleys.

PAGE 14 (SIX PANELS)

1. EXT. CITY STREET - DAY

Joy is walking down the decaying street - can't believe what's happened to The Birthplace. It's desolate.

JOY
It's not supposed to be like this.

2. EXT. CITY STREET - DAY

A low-level Asian DRUG DEALER is soliciting Joy from an alley corner. He is displaying (3) syringes in his coat pocket.

DRUG DEALER
What up, girl? Want some of this
U.P.?

JOY
U.P.?

DRUG DEALER
Unsanctioned programs. Guaranteed
to make a better you.

3. EXT. CITY STREET - DAY

Over-the-shoulder via Drug Dealer to Joy.

JOY
What is this dump?

DRUG DEALER
The Birthplace. New and improved,
baby.

JOY
You one of the customers, here to
experience childbirth? I don't see
a chip under your wrist.

DRUG DEALER
Does it look I want kids?

4. EXT. CITY STREET - DAY

Medium shot of Drug Dealer. He slices his arm (a little) with
a switchblade. A drop of BLUE BLOOD seeps from the wound.

DRUG DEALER
I'm part of the system. A program
like you. I noticed your finger, we
have the same color discharge.

5. EXT. CITY STREET - DAY

EXTREME CLOSE UP of Joy's finger with a band-aid on it. A
splash of blue can be seen underneath the band-aid; the
cactus cut from earlier.

DRUG DEALER
I guess if we lose enough of it,
we'll die. The customers discharge
red. If they run out, they just get
permanently locked out of the
system. Lucky motherfuckers.

6. EXT. CITY STREET - DAY

Close up of Joy.

DRUG DEALER
(out of frame)
So, how 'bout it? Fifty crypto for
some bomb U.P. You won't find a
sweeter deal.

JOY
Stay away from me.

A WOMAN
(out of frame)
Bitch, aren't you supposed to be
helping us?

1. EXT. THE BIRTHPLACE - GRAVEL LOT - DAY

A couple wearing street clothes, lies in a gravel lot with weeds growing from concrete. The MAN looks like a down-on-his-luck pimp. The WOMAN looks like a prostitute - she is pregnant and yelling at Joy for assistance through a rough labor. The microchips underneath their wrists are visible.

THE WOMAN
(to Joy)
Get this thing out of me!

2. EXT. THE BIRTHPLACE - GRAVEL LOT - DAY

The woman is snatching the bloody new-born baby from a confused Joy - while the man is smoking a joint beside her.

THE WOMAN
She doesn't look anything like me.
I want my money back!

THE MAN
Even with all the blood, she looks
better than you.

THE WOMAN
Screw you!

3. EXT. THE BIRTHPLACE - GRAVEL LOT - DAY

The man is holding the baby now and pretending to put the joint in the baby's mouth.

THE MAN
(to the baby)
Try it. This is that good shit.

4. EXT. THE BIRTHPLACE - DAY

Joy is watching the couple; confused, sad.

JOY
(Thought Bubble)
You people don't belong here. But
thank God your time's up.

5. EXT. THE BIRTHPLACE - DAY

Close-up of Joy's digital watch. It reads "9 Minutes"

PAGE 16 (SPLASH PAGE)**EXT. THE BIRTHPLACE - GRAVEL LOT - DAY**

Joy is shocked to see that the couple is gone but the baby that was born is still there, lying on the ground, helpless.

CAPTION

The computer virus has screwed-up everything. The children that were supposed to be pleasantly, and immediately cleared from the program's memory after birth... were now embedded in the system's storage... here to stay. Abandoned.

JOY

Why are you still here? I can't take care of you. It's not part of my job!

FOUR CUSTOMERS

(Out of frame, in labor)

- Yo, we're having a fucking baby over here!

- Get on your job, midwife!

- We were here first!

- Like hell you were!

PAGE 17 (SIX PANELS)**1. INT. COTTAGE - LIVING RM. - DAY**

There are seven babies on blanket pallets on the floor. An older woman (BABYSITTER) in her 60s wearing a maiden-style dress is sitting in a rocking chair reading a magazine. Several of the babies are crying.

CAPTION

Two days later...

BABIES

WHAAA...

2. INT. COTTAGE - LIVING RM. DAY

Joy is walking in the front door and sees what's going on, disappointed. She has a satchel with holes poked in it over her shoulder.

JOY

If you're not going to do your job properly... babysitter off.

3. INT. COTTAGE - LIVING RM. - DAY

Joy places a new baby (the eighth baby) among the other seven. While in the background, the babysitter is digitally zapped into a wall console. The babysitter is a program download.

4. INT. COTTAGE - KITCHEN - DAY

With the babies in the background, Joy has her back to them. She POUNDS the kitchen table, not wanting to deal with them. Again, not her responsibility.

SFX

(hands pounding table)

BAM!

JOY

(Thought bubble)

I don't know how to do this. Don't put this on me... what kind of midwife would turn her back on precious babies?

5. INT. COTTAGE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Joy is feeding a baby via baby bottle - while in a rocking chair. She accidentally squirts the bottle in the baby's face.

CAPTION

As days went by, Joy began to connect with the babies. She wasn't perfect, but now, it was like they were meant to be together. Good thing too, because there were surely more to come...

6. INT. COTTAGE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Joy is standing among the now 15 babies, happy.

CAPTION

Joy couldn't help but feel that
there was something special about
these little ones.

PAGE 18 (SPLASH) (BLACK AND WHITE)

EXT. GRASSY FIELD IN THE MIDDLE OF NOWHERE - NIGHT

Wide shot - A big body Mercedes sedan, it screams "rich"-
headlights on. And two men (silhouettes) can be seen near the
vehicle. One of the men is on his knees, the other stands
over him.

The below caption was in original script but didn't get
added. I think it would be helpful.

CAPTION

Back in real world London.

PAGE 19 (FOUR PANELS) (BLACK AND WHITE)

1. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

MR. FALL, dressed in a designer suit - is standing behind and
over a kneeling man. Mr. Fall is pointing a Desert Eagle
handgun right at the back of the man's head. Moments from
killing him. The man is one of Mr. Fall's MARKs and the guy
is scared as hell.

NOTE: MR. FALL'S ENTIRE INTRO SEQUENCE/PANELS SHOULD BE A BIT
MORE AGGRESSIVE IN PRESENTATION (CANTED ANGLES, ETC). My SHOT
RECOMMENDATIONS ARE GUIDEPOSTS BUT PLEASE FEEL FREE TO BE
CREATIVE HERE.

THE MARK

Whatever he's paying you --

MR. FALL

Let me guess, you'll double it?
That shit doesn't work in the
movies. Damn sure won't work on me.

THE MARK

Please, I have a wife.

MR. FALL
A wife. What's that like?

2. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

Close up - Mr. Fall is getting a little emotional, not crying, just really intrigued.

THE MARK
(Out of frame)
... It's wonderful. Having someone
to come home to every night...
there's nothing like it.

MR. FALL
Kids?

THE MARK
(Out of frame)
No... having children... that's a
crime.

3. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

Mr. Fall has blown a hole in the back of the Mark's head,
brain matter everywhere, killing him.

SFX
BLAM!

MR. FALL
Not as much as this.

4. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

Close up - Mr. Fall brushes the back of his own hair with his
old/scratched-up hairbrush, a device that never leaves his
side, it's seen years of use. At the same time, two gun
barrels are pointed at the back of Mr. Fall's head.

POLICE OFFICER
(Out of frame)
Drop the gun!

MR. FALL
Fuck...

1. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

Wide profile shot - Two POLICE OFFICERS are holding guns on Mr. Fall. Mr. Fall is now facing them, his gun is now on the ground. A GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL wearing a conservative suit is with the officers, he's a stuffy looking guy, the brains of the bunch. The Mark's dead body lays on the ground.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
Willard Benjamin Falery?

MR. FALL
Mr. Fall to you and the entire
universe.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
Contract killer for London's most
vile drug lords.

MR. FALL
I must correct you. I've never
signed a contract. We use the
honour system.

2. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

New angle (reverse) - Through the Mercedes car window might be cool. Just Mr. Fall and the Government Official.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
I work for the government. And I'd
like to offer you a job. Pro Bono,
of course.

MR. FALL (SHOUT BUBBLE)
Ha, ha, ha... doing what? Making
number plates?

3. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

Over-the-shoulder via Government Official. Mr. Fall's face should be dominant.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
What do you know about The
Birthplace?

MR. FALL
I know it used to be for the elite
until someone fucked with it and
put the microchips on the black
market.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
We want to reset the system. Make
it more desirable.

MR. FALL
You mean more profitable.

4. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

God shot looking up at Mr. Fall and Government Official - the
Mark's dead body in the foreground.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
There's a bug inside of the program
that carries an encryption code. We
can't do a full reset until the
host of said encryption code is...
eliminated. That's where you come
in.

MR. FALL
And if I tell you to bog off?

5. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT

Medium shot of Mr. Fall. The Government Official is holding
the microchip in front Mr. Fall, offering it to him.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
(Out of frame)
Need I remind you that
overpopulation has made us Brits
reconsider the death penalty. After
your recent encounter with this
poor fellow, I'd say you're at the
front of the line.

PAGE 21 (FOUR PANELS)

1. EXT. RUNDOWN WAREHOUSE - DAY

A decaying sign on the building, (a few missing letters)
reads "Member Services" - there is no one in sight.

CAPTION
The Birthplace: Member Services
building - The entryway for all
customers. This is where the
debauchery and birthing details are
"laid" out.

2. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - DAY

Bird's eye. A large room with cheap blanket pallets sprawled all over the floor (THINK OF MAKESHIFT HOMELESS SHELTER). Loose trash scattered about. Holograms aligning the walls show different sexual positions. (NOTE: Use discretion here, don't want X-rated).

Mr. Fall is laying on his back on one of the blankets in the center of the room, eyes closed. He's wearing the same suit he had on before.

3. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - DAY

Close-up on Mr. Fall as he has just opened his eyes.

4. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - DAY

Mr. Fall is sitting up, looking at his wrist, the microchip embedded under his skin.

PAGE 22 (FIVE PANELS)**1. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - CONCIERGE DESK - DAY**

It is a partitioned-off area, like a coat check area only larger. Sex toys adorn the walls inside of the concierge area.

Mr. Fall is at the desk. MIA, a sexy female AI attendant, is behind the desk.

MIA

You must be special. I heard they weren't letting any more customers inside. Some sort of maintenance issue.

MR. FALL

I'm not exactly a customer.

MIA

So... just here to kill time?

MR. FALL

Among other things.

2. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - CONCIERGE DESK - DAY

Mr. Fall is looking at the empty warehouse behind him.

MR. FALL
Where is everybody?

MIA
Around. All looking to commit acts
of hedonism. Speaking of
hedonism...

3. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - CONCIERGE DESK - DAY

Mia has placed a whip, chain, and handcuffs on the counter for Mr. Fall's choosing. But behind the Robot Attendant is a small box sitting on a table with "Mr. Fall" written on it. Mr. Fall is pointing at the box.

MIA
I've got whips, handcuffs... What's
your pleasure?

MR. FALL
How 'bout the box with my name on
it?

4. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - CONCIERGE DESK - DAY

Close-up - Mr. Fall has opened the box. Inside of the box is a hairbrush, a huge upgrade from the one he had in real-world London. There is a high-tech touch screen on the back of it - with the word "Download" on the screen.

MR. FALL
Helluva upgrade.

5. INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - CONCIERGE DESK - DAY

Extreme close-up of brush's touch screen. Mr. Fall presses the "download" button on the screen - there's an image of a high-tech rifle on the screen as well.

PAGE 23 (SINGLE SPLASH)

INT. MEMBER SERVICES WAREHOUSE - DAY

Mr. Fall is headed for the exit - in one hand... toting that big-ass rifle he just downloaded, and brushing his hair with the other hand. Mia is in the background yelling at him.

MIA
Hey, what kind of kinky shit are
you into?!

PAGE 24 (THREE PANELS)**1. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY**

Wide shot - slides, swing sets - in the middle of a shady metropolis.

Joy is on the ground playing with some of the babies. Others are in Joy's mode of transportation parked nearby, a futuristic car with a hovering see-through trailer attached.

CAPTION
Meanwhile - In the heart of The
Birthplace...

2. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY

Joy slides down the slide holding one of the babies. Smiling, laughing.

JOY
(Shouting)
Weeee...

3. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY

Joy holds one of the baby's backsides up to her face to smell. A sagging diaper is clearly noticeable.

JOY
You stink.

PAGE 25 (THREE PANELS)**1. EXT. JUNKYARD OVERLOOKING THE PLAYGROUND - DAY**

POV - THROUGH THE RIFLE SCOPE - Joy is changing the baby's diaper on the ground.

2. EXT. JUNKYARD OVERLOOKING THE PLAYGROUND - DAY

Crushed and bent up cars scattered about, piled high. But a fancy, big SUV is parked on the edge of the lot -

Mr. Fall is laying across the roof of the SUV. His rifle trained below, sniper style.

3. EXT. JUNKYARD OVERLOOKING THE PLAYGROUND - DAY

Mr. Fall has his sights set on the group below. An image of Joy is emitting from his brush with the words: "System Volume File - Do Not Delete."

MR. FALL

As long as she stays out of my way.

PAGE 26 (FIVE PANELS)**1. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY**

Over the shoulder via Joy's point of view. She is on the ground changing the baby's diaper.

JOY

(to the baby she's
changing)

You'd think I'd be good at this by
now.

SFX (GUNSHOT - OUT OF FRAME)

BOOM!

2. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY

The baby that Joy was changing has turned into DIGITAL ASHES.
(NOTE: This image should look as haunting as possible, without blood/guts).

3. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY

Close-up. Joy is holding the baby's ashes in her hands.
Horried.

JOY
What is this, coding... some kind
of encryption?

4. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY

Joy is watching another baby turn to digital ashes.

JOY
Who's doing this?

5. EXT. PLAYGROUND - DAY

Shellshocked, Joy is looking up and sees the shadowy figure of Mr. Fall at his sniper position - the glint of his scope twinkling from the sun.

PAGE 27 (TWO PANELS)

1. EXT. JUNKYARD OVERLOOKING THE PLAYGROUND - DAY

Mr. Fall is still in his sniper position trying to clear his gun jam, annoyed. Below and at a distance, we can see Joy running to her vehicle with a bunch of the babies.

MR. FALL
(Thought bubble)
Gun jam. How does this happen
inside of a fucking program? -- I
forgot, that government prick
warned me about this...

2. EXT. GRASSY FIELD - NIGHT (BLACK AND WHITE)

The Government Official and Officers addressing Mr. Fall.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
We'll support you in any way
possible. But the virus has reduced
the system's RAM, limiting our
capabilities - and not everything
will always work to perfection.

PAGE 28 (THREE PANELS)

1. EXT. CITY STREETS - NIGHT

Joy is driving her truck with trailer, speeding down the narrow streets. There are just a few other cars on the road. They are futuristic but not all in the best shape. Have fun and be creative with these vehicles.

JOY
I thought I was cut out for this,
I'm not. I was programmed to help
deliver babies, not protect them.

2. EXT. CITY STREETS - NIGHT

Medium shot - In the trailer, robotic arms are changing the babies' diapers and bottle feeding them.

3. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Joy is walking away from the Truck/trailer. The babies are still inside. Signage on the nearby building awning reads "D&C's Pawn Shop"

JOY
I'm sorry.

PAGE 29 (FIVE PANELS)**1. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT**

Joy is sitting on the ground against a wall, sulking.

JOY
(thought bubble)
I must go back.

2. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Close-up - Joy is pounding the ground.

JOY
(thought bubble, out of
frame)
They're in danger.

3. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Joy is now standing; her forehead is touching the brick wall. She is distressed as all hell.

JOY
(thought bubble)
I have everything I need to do
this.

CAPTION
But she didn't truly believe it.

4. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Joy sees the same Drug Dealer from earlier walking down the street.

JOY
(thought bubble)
The drug dealer. He said the U.P.
was guaranteed to make a better
you.

5. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Close-up - Once again, Joy is speaking into her wristwatch.

JOY
Download fifty crypto.

PAGE 30 (TWO PANELS)

1. EXT. CITY STREET - BUS STOP - NIGHT

Joy is sitting on a bus stop bench. Syringe in hand.

CAPTION
Five minutes later...

2. EXT. CITY STREET - BUS STOP - NIGHT

Close-up of Joy injecting the syringe into her arm.

PAGE 31 (FOUR PANELS)

1. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is driving in his car when he spots Joy's vehicle.

MR. FALL
I must say, I've seen better hiding
places.

2. EXT ALLEY - NIGHT

Mr. Fall aims a handgun at the babies in the trailer, getting ready to kill them all. A tear forming in his eye.

JOY
(Out of frame)
Leave them alone.

3. EXT. ALLEY NIGHT

Joy stands in the shadows. Face and body obscured.

MR. FALL
You're the bitch who ran off with
your tail between your legs.

JOY
That bitch is long gone.

MR. FALL
Just like these brats in about five
seconds.

JOY
You won't make it to three.

4. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of Joy's face. We see her high-tech goggles, a glint in her eyes, lips curled, she looks extremely dangerous. This is the new and improved Joy.

JOY
I don't know who the hell you are,
and I don't care. But I do care
about those children. If you lay
one finger on them, I will be
forced to fuck you up.

5. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of Mr. Fall's face.

MR. FALL
You must have a death wish?

PAGE 32 (SINGLE SPLASH)**EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT**

We see Joy from behind, full body. She is looking toward Mr. Fall. Joy is gripping badass futuristic handgun handle that is currently in her waistband behind her back. She even has a few knives in her waistband. Her other hand to her side, balled into a fist. She's ready for war. And Mr. Fall has no clue.

JOY
It's not about me anymore. From now on... I ride for them.

CHAPTER 2**PAGE 3 (SINGLE SPLASH) BLACK/WHITE****EXT. BETTER YOU PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - NIGHT**

A large 3-story complex. Part early 20th century, part futuristic (idea is to subliminally convey conflict of the patients inside). It has an archway and pillars, and a guard shack. Holographic sign projected on the lawn reads:

"A Better You Psychiatric Hospital"

CAPTION
London, England. The Year 2052.

PAGE 4 (FOUR PANELS) BLACK/WHITE**1. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT**

Medium shot - From behind a serving counter, a FEMALE FOOD SERVICE WORKER is slapping mashed potatoes on Ava's plate on the other side of the counter. Ava is holding her tray with her plate on it.

Ava is dressed in loose fitting hospital garb (scrubs) and looks disheveled. Other female patients in the b.g. sit at tables eating (all in identical scrubs).

CHARLOTTE is standing in line beside Ava waiting for her potatoes. It is evident that Ava wants nothing to do with her.

NOTE: Please see character description for Charlotte.

CHARLOTTE

I heard you're the lassie who put
the virus in that baby program.
Turned everything upside down.

2. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT

Ava is at the automatic beverage dispenser now, filling her cup with a soft drink.

Charlotte is beside her (uncomfortably close), hounding.

CHARLOTTE

If those bastards tried to cut me
out and take credit for something I
thought up, I would've done the
same --

3. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT

Still holding her food tray, Ava is approaching a FLOATING DRONE manning a table with several miniature labeled cups with pill cocktails inside of each cup (meds for the patients).

The Floating Drone has two extended robotic arms that extend from its body. One arm is already holding out a cup toward Ava.

In the background or foreground, we can see a UNCOOPERATIVE FEMALE PATIENT on the ground being violently force fed her meds by another floating drone.

Charlotte is still tagging alongside Ava, holding her own food tray.

FLOATING DRONE

Recommended treatment for Ava
Campbell.

UNCOOPERATIVE FEMALE PATIENT

Aaahhh!

4. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT

Close-up. Ava is holding a cup up to her mouth, downing two pills. The label on the cup reads:

"Quetiapine"

We can see Charlotte eyeballing the label on the cup.

CHARLOTTE

-- Then again, I can't entirely blame them. Being bipolar or schizophrenic doesn't exactly make you the poster child for reproductive excellence.

PAGE 5 (THREE PANELS) BLACK/WHITE

1. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT

Wide shot - Ava is sitting at a table biting into an apple. Charlotte is sitting next to her, badgering.

CHARLOTTE

But coming to the bin on your own to avoid the courts... you get a gold star for that.

2. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT

Close-up 2-shot of Ava and Charlotte. Charlotte is whispering into Ava's ear.

CHARLOTTE

I'm Charlotte. If you ever need...

3. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - NIGHT

Ava has had enough. She is whacking the shit out of Charlotte's face with her food tray. Food is flying. One of Charlotte's teeth is knocked out, we can see it flying through the air toward us/the reader.

This is a violent scene.

SFX

KAAARAK

PAGE 6 (TWO PANELS) COLOR UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE**1. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT (CONT. FROM LAST PAGE OF ISSUE 1)**

Mr. Fall is getting shot in his right collar by Joy. Blood (red) spatters. His gun is flying out of his hand.

NOTE: Angle from behind Mr. Fall and he should be falling toward us/reader. And we see Joy in front of him pointing her handgun at him/toward us.

Framing is important as we would like the reader to be immersed, almost as if they are being shot by Joy. This should be eerily similar to the way Charlotte got hit.

CAPTION

The Birthplace.

SFX

(gun shot)

BOOM

2. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Joy is on top of Mr. Fall as he lays on the ground face-up. Her gun is pointed toward his face, but Mr. Fall is clutching her wrist, forcing the gun to the side. The gun's projectile shoots into the ground right beside Mr. Fall's head.

NOTE: Would like this to be very aggressive. Should see both their faces (profile shot?) Their faces should be close together. Joy's facial expression should be evil-looking. Mr. Fall is struggling.

SFX

(gunshot)

THUD

PAGE 7 (FIVE PANELS)**1. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT**

Mr. Fall is kicking Joy off of him.

SFX

WHAM

2. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Joy is hitting a brick wall like a sack of potatoes. Her gun is falling out of her hand.

SFX
(wall impact)
OOOMPH

3. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is crawling toward his gun while Joy is recovering from the hit to the wall.

4. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

Close-up of Mr. Fall's hand reaching for his gun. Two of Joy's blades stabs/sticks into his hand.

MR. FALL
(out of frame)
AAHHHH

5. EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

From Joy's angle while she is still on the ground, we see Mr. Fall running off down an adjacent corridor (most of his body is already out of view - as Joy is shooting three rounds at him, missing, hitting the wall. Mr. Fall escapes.

SFX
(bullets hitting wall)
THWIP-THWIP-THWIP

JOY
Coward!

PAGE 8, 9 (DOUBLE SPLASH)

EXT. HOUSE - NIGHT

Wide shot - Joy is driving her car (with baby trailer) up a gravel driveway toward a medium-sized 2-story house.

The house is in the middle of nowhere. It was once a luxurious brick home, but now severely rundown. Dirty bay windows, decaying front porch with a rocking swing.

PAGE 10 (FOUR PANELS)**1. INT. HOUSE - FOYER - NIGHT**

Joy is entering through the front door. It is fairly dark in the house.

Someone is hiding in the shadows behind the front door aiming an old-school double barrel shotgun, waiting to shoot Joy. Joy is oblivious. (We cannot see the threat's face)

Note: Joy does not have goggles on her face. She still has her weapons etc although she is not carrying them.

2. INT. HOUSE - FOYER - NIGHT

Close up - Joy grabs the barrel with both hands.

3. INT. HOUSE - FOYER - NIGHT

Still holding the barrel, Joy is flipping the assailant in mid-air. During this move, we still don't see the person's face.

4. INT. HOUSE - FOYER - NIGHT

Close up reveal of D+ (the assailant) as Joy is pointing the shotgun at his face. Would like just the barrel and D+ face in this frame.

D+ is scared as shit.

D+
A squared plus B squared equals C
squared!

PAGE 11 (FIVE PANELS)**1. INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT**

Large room. Antique, tattered furniture. Thick binder math books scattered everywhere like a messy library, even some on bookshelves. A huge fireplace, fire is burning.

Mirrors (both handheld type, and wall mounted) scattered throughout the room for D+ convenience to see formulas on his face. This is not a glass house, so maybe a dozen or so, if that.

Joy is sitting on a couch across from D+. The shotgun leaned against the end table beside her. The babies are on the floor terrorizing his books, ripping pages etc.

D+ has sweat beads on his forehead, he is clutching one of his books; holding close to his chest. He's anxious, looking at the babies.

D+

Those books are very important to me. Please tell them to stop.

JOY

They're babies, doing what babies do.

2. INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Medium shot of D+ only - still on the couch. He is now looking at Joy.

D+

How do you know me? What makes you think I'm prepared to care for them?

3. INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Medium shot of Joy only. She looks confused, maybe looking down.

JOY

I don't know. Someone... or something just... told me to come here... that I can trust you.

4. INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

MAYBE A CHALLENGING PANEL HERE:

D+ is standing at the fireplace mantel, setting the book he was clutching back on the mantel. He is staring at himself in a large mirror that is over the mantel.

It would be cool if we could also see Joy in the mirror (reflection) sitting on the couch behind D+. But whole point is to make the connection that D+ can simply look in the mirror to remember any of the math formulas on his face. An emotional moment for him.

A framed photo of his parents (a lovely-looking couple) is already sitting on the mantel nearby, no need to draw attention to it.

JOY

So your name is D+... Not a name
you hear every day.

D+

That was my algebra grade in
secondary school. Embarrassed my
genius parents. For punishment,
they told everyone in town,
including my friends, to start
calling me D+. It stuck.

JOY

Your parents, they do that to your
face?

5. INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Medium shot of D+ (only). He is now looking directly toward Joy.

In one hand, he is holding a (old-school looking) handheld soldering tool with a very fine tip (we can see that the tip is extremely hot, small traces of smoke emitting from the tip). This is what he uses to brand formulas on his face.

NOTE: Please be wide enough to show some of his bare arm. Want to show that he has no formulas/scarring on his hands and arms.

D+

No. I did. So I won't forget the
formulas.

JOY

(out of frame)

Couldn't you just put the formulas
on your hands and arms?

D+

Are you mad? That would hurt.

PAGE 12 (THREE PANELS)

1. INT. MR. FALL'S SUV - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is driving, gripping the steering wheel with left hand. Blood is gushing from right shoulder wound. He is looking woozy.

2. INT. MR. FALL'S SUV - NIGHT

Close-up of Mr. Fall's right hand holding his brush (display side up). The display reads:

"Updating"

MR. FALL
(out of frame)
I don't need a bloody update, I
need the location for medical care.
Now!

3. INT. MR. FALL'S SUV - NIGHT

Mr. Fall's eyes are closed and his body is slumped to the side.

MR. FALL
If I die, I'll be locked out of the
system... I can't go to prison...

PAGE 13 (TWO PANELS)**1. EXT. CITY STREET - NIGHT**

DOMINANT PANEL - Mr. Fall's SUV has crashed into a light pole. Mr. Fall has been thrown through the windshield. We see him in mid-flight.

2. EXT. CITY STREET - NIGHT

SMALLER PANEL - Mr. Fall is on the ground unconscious.

PAGE 14 (FIVE PANELS)**1. INT. LOFT - OPEN CONCEPT - NIGHT**

The spacious condo is sterile and pristine with a futuristic flair. Almost everything is white and chrome. Total opposite of the D+ home.

Mia, (the woman/AI from the member services office) is at the kitchen island, slicing an orange with a miniature laser tool. She is wearing tight jeans and a cut-off tee shirt.

2. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is exiting a bedroom wearing a robe and house shoes, and holding/flexing his once wounded shoulder.

MIA
Feeling better?

MR. FALL
Much. You did this?

MIA
Not only do I have a flair for
foreplay, I was programmed with
enhanced emergency medical
capacities. Sometimes customers get
a little too rough for their own
good if you know what I mean.

3. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is sitting on a stool at the kitchen island across from Mia.

Mia is placing the plate of sliced orange in front of Mr. Fall.

MR. FALL
What's your name?

MIA
Mia.

MR. FALL
Thanks, Mia. I owe you one.

4. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Mia has walked behind Mr. Fall as he eats a slice of orange. Mia is touching the back of his head, checking on a wound he sustained earlier. This is the spot he brushes his hair at.

5. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is violently grabbing her wrist, squeezing. Mia is slightly frightened.

MR. FALL
What are you doing?

MIA
You had a wound there. I was just checking on it.

MR. FALL
Don't touch the back of my head.
Understand?

MIA
I understand. Now let go of me.

PAGE 15 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is walking across the loft toward a large window. Mia is coddling her wrist. Laying across a chair we can see a brand new suit for Mr. Fall (identical to his other suit) and his hi-tech brush setting on top of it.

MIA
The one that shot you, is it the same one that gave you such bad manners?

2. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is looking out the window (he is looking toward us/the reader). Mia is standing in the background looking at Mr. Fall.

MR. FALL
No. It was a program. Dressed in scrubs.

MIA
You mean, Joy?

3. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Close-up on Mr. Fall's face. He is looking over his shoulder toward Mia. He looks surprised.

MIA
(out of frame)
Are you okay? You look like you've just seen a ghost.

MR. FALL
I'm fine. This Joy, what do you
know about her?

MIA
(out of frame)
She's a midwife. Helps deliver
babies... I don't understand, Joy
wouldn't hurt a fly.

4. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is nose to nose with Mia. A devilish grin on his
face.

MR. FALL
Apparently you don't know her very
well. But system volume file or
not, she's dead.

5. INT. LOFT - NIGHT

Close-up of Mr. Fall's hands grabbing his suit and brush from
the chair.

PAGE 16 (THREE PANELS)

1. EXT. D+ HOUSE - OUTSIDE LIVING ROOM WINDOW - NIGHT

(From just outside the window) Joy is staring out the first
floor window, looking toward us/the reader and polishing her
handgun with a rag at the same time, she's deep in thought.

D+ is in the background sitting on the floor in front of the
babies. Babies are arranged like a classroom as they lay on
individual baby pods. We don't see babies faces here.

D+ is holding a chalkboard, teaching the kids.

2. INT. D+ HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Medium shot of just D+ holding up chalkboard with a math
equation on it, teaching the babies.

D+
Mathematics can open doors to
extraordinary opportunities. Now,
repeat after me, seven is the
square root of forty-nine.

3. INT. D+ HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Medium shot of babies. They are all fast asleep.

D+
(out of frame)
This is hopeless.

PAGE 17 (FOUR PANELS)

1. INT. D+ HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Joy is sitting in the adjacent/connected dining room at the dining room table - spinning her large sword/blade on the table. There's a few balled up pieces of paper on the table. D+ is walking toward her.

JOY
You're good with numbers, how many customers do you estimate are out there?

D+
Quite a few.

JOY
Quite a few? Not the specificity I would expect from a math wiz.

2. INT. D+ HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Joy and D+ are sitting across from each other at the table.
(Let's have them sit opposite of what they were on Page 11, or whatever we can do to switch up the angle; Thanks!)

D+
How about this, twenty-five hundred.

JOY
Equals what? --

D+
-- The square-footage of this house. Not much room for more babies.

JOY
I haven't received a delivery notification in some time. Perhaps someone fixed the program.

3. INT. D+ HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Close-up on sword/blade twirling on the table. There is a wrinkled up piece of paper on the table next to the blade.

4. INT. D+ HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Close-up of the unfolded piece of paper that Joy is now holding. It is a flyer that has a huge Cathedral-looking building on it (no religious symbols). The headline on the flyer reads:

"Tonight" "The Orgy Oracle Grand Opening" "All Customers Welcome"

JOY

Shit.

PAGE 18 (TWO PANELS)

1. EXT. ORGY PARTY - NIGHT

DOMINANT PANEL. Wide shot - Front of orgy party. Party search lights. PATRONS stand in line, others milling about.

Joy has just pulled up on a black futuristic naked/sport bike (she's still sitting on it). Somewhere on the side of the bike: an engraved small decal of a cactus plant.

NOTE: The Patrons outside and inside are considered "Customers" - so the "green chip" on their wrist should be evident if wrists are visible. The Bouncer, Manager, DJ are programs, so no chip for them.

2. EXT. ORGY PARTY - NIGHT

SMALLER PANEL. Joy is at the entrance with a huge BOUNCER manning the door. He is stopping her from entering.

The Patron (female) at the front of the line contests Joy's line cutting.

FEMALE PATRON

(to Joy)

No line cutting, hag. Besides, no chance you're getting shagged in that ensemble.

BOUNCER
(to Joy)
Customers only.

PAGE 19 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. ORACLE - MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

A BIG party, mostly dark, just colorful effect lighting. Bass vibrating large speakers.

Joy is overwhelmed - standing amongst a MASSIVE CROWD OF PEOPLE (customers) dancing, most of which are wearing just undergarments (this should be tastefully done, nothing explicit or too sexually graphic in this sequence - perhaps some silhouettes with help make it look more packed).

There is a HI-TECH DJ (Wearing only boxers) on a platform. The ORACLE MANAGER has a microphone, acting as MC beside the DJ, he's holding up 3 fingers (and is wearing a suit).

Above the crowd is a large monitor with a countdown that reads:

"2:58"

ORACLE MANAGER
Three minutes until mass
debauchery!

2. INT. ORACLE - MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

Joy is on the DJ platform snatching the mic from the Oracle Manager.

3. INT. ORACLE - MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

Over-the-shoulder of Joy as she addresses the massive crowd which is totally ignoring her.

JOY
Party's over. Everyone leave. Now!

JOY (CONT'D)
(thought bubble)
Why aren't they leaving?

4. INT. ORACLE - MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

Joy is looking just off the side of the DJ platform and sees a fire alarm on the wall.

JOY
(thought bubble)
The fire alarm!

5. INT. ORACLE - MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

Joy has just pulled the fire alarm. She looks worried.

JOY
(thought bubble)
Sonofabitch, it doesn't work!

PAGE 20 (FIVE PANELS)**1. EXT. ORACLE - FRONT ENTRANCE - NIGHT**

From behind Mr. Fall - we see Mr. Fall nonchalantly walking in the front door, passing by the Bouncer who is now hanging upside down on the wall, one of his legs affixed to the wall with multiple blades through his pants/flesh - (knives) from Joy. He is alive but in pain. The blood from his wounds are the **color blue**.

MR. FALL
I see the midwife left you hanging.

BOUNCER
Screw you, get me down!

2. INT. ORACLE - MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

From behind, Joy is walking up a narrow staircase. No other people in this panel.

3. INT. ORACLE - MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is searching the crowd, his gun is drawn. In the background we can see the big monitor. The time reads:

"1:45"

MR. FALL
 (thought bubble)
 Gonna be lots of encryption hosts
 to eliminate, I'll deal with them
 later. The first bullet is spoken
 for. Where are you, Joy?

4. INT. ORACLE - RAFTERS ABOVE MAIN ROOM - NIGHT

Medium close-up. Joy is sitting on the floor against a rail. A look of indifference. Her visor/goggles are fizzling into existence over her eyes.

JOY
 Not everyone gets a moment like
 this. Don't take it for granted.

5. INT. ORACLE - NIGHT

Unbeknownst to Mr. Fall, he is standing at the bottom of the staircase Joy climbed a moment ago. But he is looking toward the crowd instead, still searching for Joy.

MR. FALL (THOUGHT BUBBLE)
 I know you're here somewhere.

PAGE 21 (FOUR PANELS)

1. INT. ORACLE - RAFTERS - NIGHT

Medium shot - looking at Joy - she is leaned over the railing, aiming a gigantic UZI-like gun at the customers/crowd below. Her visor is fully realized now.

NOTE: Let's try a trail effect on Joy as she leans over the rail, would like to express the movement from sitting to final position.

The big monitor in the background reads:

"0:05"

JOY
 I told you to leave.

2. INT. ORACLE - RAFTERS - NIGHT

Over-the-shoulder from Mr. Fall's perspective - He is watching Joy shoot at the crowd below, bullets spraying out of her gun. Even from this distance we can see that Joy has a lollipop in her mouth.

NOTE: We don't need to see the carnage below. And no sound effects for gun shots and crowd screams.

3. INT. ORACLE - RAFTERS - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of Joy with lollipop in her mouth.

MR. FALL
(out of frame)
What the hell...

4. INT. SHOOTING RANGE - NIGHT - BLACK/WHITE

This is a flashback panel:

Medium close-up. The shooting range has traditional stalls. But we focus on one stall looking at Ava and Mr. Fall. They are both about ten years younger. They both have headphone/ear protection.

Mr. Fall is behind Ava helping her aim her pistol, teaching her. They are both happy, there's chemistry there. Ava has a lollipop in her mouth just like Joy.

CAPTION
London, England. About ten years
ago.

PAGE 22 (SINGLE SPLASH) COLOR

INT. ORACLE - RAFTERS - NIGHT

Extreme close-up on Mr. Fall's eyes, so close we can see the reflection in his eyes of Joy shooting at the crowd below... and Ava.

MR. FALL
Ava?

CHAPTER 3**PAGE 3 (SINGLE SPLASH) BLACK/WHITE****EXT. APARTMENT BUILDING - NIGHT**

A two-story complex. Borderline impoverished. Bars on some of the windows. Average cars parked on the street. This area is not as high-tech as the city, it's like this part of town has been left behind.

CAPTION

London, England. The year 2041.
Before the ban on childbirth.

PAGE 4 (FIVE PANELS) BLACK/WHITE**1. INT. MR. FALL'S SMALL STUDIO APARTMENT - NIGHT**

Wide shot - Second hand furniture, hardwood floors. Despite the modest belongings, it is a tidy place. The only techy item in here is the large holographic projection TV.

Ava is sitting on a futon watching TV. Mr. Fall is kneeling in front of her. We are trying to insinuate Mr. Fall is performing a sex act on Ava. So, whatever angle chosen needs to hide what he's actually doing (to be revealed in next panel). So, maybe best angle is from behind, whatever works best :)

IMPORTANT: On the TV screen, **we can clearly see** a news broadcast. A NEWS REPORTER along with footage of a crime scene (police tape). The caption/text on the TV should read: "Murders and Muggings Increase in New Water Area."

AVA

Yes. That's it, that's the spot.

2. INT. MR. FALL'S STUDIO APARTMENT - NIGHT

Medium shot/now in front of characters - Mr. Fall is actually happily listening to Ava's plump belly, she is unmistakably pregnant. At the same time, Ava is rubbing the back of Mr. Fall's head, the same spot he always brushes his hair. Ava is looking straight ahead, never taking her eyes off the TV, engrossed (*we don't need to see TV screen here).

They both are about ten years younger (similar to when they were at gun range). They have on regular clothes. Jeans/tee shirts.

On the end table, we can see a photo of Ava and Mr. Fall with their names on the photo as well: "Willard and Ava" --

Beside the photo we can also see a text book titled: "Training for the British Army"

MR. FALL

I feel her. She's strong... and happy. We should name her Joy.

AVA

Joy doesn't quite fit. How about different? Yes, let's name her "Different."

3. INT. MR. FALL'S STUDIO APARTMENT - NIGHT

2-shot (closer) - Mr. Fall is now sitting up beside Ava, looking at Ava. He is deeply concerned. Ava doesn't make eye contact with him, she is still fixed on the TV (*we don't need to see TV screen here).

MR. FALL

Did you take your medicine?

AVA

Yes. Got it refilled today.

MR. FALL

That's my girl.

4. INT. MR. FALL'S STUDIO APARTMENT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is walking toward the bathroom. We can see Ava still sitting on the couch in the background.

MR. FALL

It's getting late. I'll hit the loo, then take you home. Camden's quite a hike.

5. INT. MR. FALL'S STUDIO APARTMENT - NIGHT

Ava is exiting the apartment. She is carrying a purse. She's sneaking out without Mr. Fall knowing.

PAGE 5 (FIVE PANELS) BLACK/WHITE**1. EXT. LONDON STREETS - NEIGHBORHOOD - NIGHT**

Ava is walking on the sidewalk. There are a few HARMLESS LOOKING PEOPLE hanging out, minding their business.

2. EXT. LONDON STREETS - NEIGHBORHOOD - NIGHT

Ava is leaving a fork in the road with a street level billboard/sign that reads: "Camden" (with an arrow pointing one way, and "New Water Area" (with an arrow pointing the opposite way).

Ava is walking toward the dangerous New Water Area.

3. EXT. NEW WATER AREA - STREETS - NIGHT

Wide shot - A worse neighborhood than Mr. Fall's. Dimly lit storefronts.

Derelicts, prostitutes, a pimp just hanging out. They all look toward Ava as she is walking down the street.

Ava looks uncomfortable, clutching her purse.

4. EXT. NEW WATER AREA - STREETS - NIGHT

Ava walks past a DRUG DEALER, making eye contact with him. The Drug Dealer looks eerily similar to the Drug Dealer Joy met in the Birthplace, except he has on different clothing.

5. EXT. NEW WATER AREA - ALLEY - NIGHT

Ava is walking down a dark alley and sees two SHADOWY FIGURES (two men), and one of them is holding a knife. And Strangely, Ava has a slight grin on her face.

Maybe angle this from behind Shadowy Figures so we can see Ava's face.

PAGE 6 (SINGLE SPLASH) BLACK/WHITE**INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT**

Mr. Fall is talking to a DOCTOR. Mr. Fall looks absolutely defeated. In the room behind them, we can see Ava laying on a hospital bed. One of her arms is in a cast. She looks pretty messed up. She's hooked up to a monitoring system (she is not on her death bed and she is conscious).

CAPTION

Three days later...

DOCTOR

Sorry. The baby didn't make it. We did everything we could...

PAGE 7 (FIVE PANELS) BLACK/WHITE**1. INT. HOSPITAL - AVA'S ROOM - NIGHT**

Medium shot - Mr. Fall is sitting in a chair at Ava's bedside. They are looking at each other. Ava has bandages/scars on her face. A bandage on the side of her belly.

Mr. Fall is showing her an empty medicine bottle. The label on the side of the bottle reads, you guessed it: "Quetiapine"

There's a cup of water on Ava's night stand - and - also a vase with flowers/card that reads: "Get Well Soon, D+"

MR. FALL

Authorities found contents from your purse. Bottle's empty. You lied to me.

2. INT. HOSPITAL - AVA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Close-up of Ava.

MR. FALL
(out of frame)
You went there intentionally. You
wanted this to happen.

AVA
Either she would have ended up like
me or I would never be right for
her.

3. INT. HOSPITAL - AVA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Close-up of Mr. Fall.

MR. FALL
I can never forgive you.

AVA
(out of frame)
That's a chance I was willing to
take.

4. INT. HOSPITAL - AVA'S ROOM. - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is walking out of the room, out of her life.

5. INT. HOSPITAL - AVA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Close up - Ava has peeled back the bandage on the side of her
stomach, revealing a sutured scar. **It is in the shape of a
Cactus plant. Alas, we find out the significance!**

*Please include this new caption:

CAPTION
The assault left her with a scar
resembling a Cactus Plant -- Which
became a symbol of her
unpredictable behavior?

PAGE 8 (TWO PANELS) - COLORED PAGES UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE

1. INT. ORGY NIGHT CLUB - DANCE FLOOR - NIGHT

Wide shot - Joy is walking across the dance floor. Lots of
blood on the floor, but no bodies. Blood should be red.

We can see the DJ and the Manager cowering behind the
turntable mix board.

CAPTION 1

The Birthplace. Where we left off...

CAPTION 2

After Joy killed the customers, they were all instantly removed from the program. Permanently locked out. Only their blood remained. And the best part, no new babies.

2. INT. ORGY NIGHT CLUB - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is behind a pillar watching Joy walk across the dance floor and toward a hallway. Her back is to him. Mr. Fall is confused, doesn't know what the hell is going on.

MR. FALL

(thought bubble)

Stay focused.

PAGE 9 (THREE PANELS)

1. INT. ORGY NIGHT CLUB - BATHROOM - NIGHT

It's dirty, unkempt (reference issue #2 cover for look/feel).

Joy is standing at the sink, looking at her reflection in the mirror, pondering.

JOY

(thought bubble)

Is this who I am?

CAPTION

... She hears a noise coming from a bathroom stall...

2. INT. ORGY NIGHT CLUB - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Joy has kicked open the stall, and sees a half-naked COUPLE holding a BABY. The Couple is totally zonked (under the influence of something strong).

Joy is holding a knife, prepared for anything (please match the knife to the one on issue #2 cover).

3. INT. ORGY NIGHT CLUB - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Wide shot - Mr. Fall has kicked the bathroom door open. An "Emergency Exit" door is wide open (Joy's exit out of the building). Angle should be wide so we get perspective of door, exit door, stall. Exit door POV may work well, doesn't necessarily have to be from Mr. Fall's POV.

The Woman is standing by the stall, smiling, like she's still cradling the baby, but her baby is now gone, too drugged-up to notice.

CAPTION

Joy is gone. Missed her by seconds.
But Mr. Fall is quickly...

4. INT. ORGY NIGHT CLUB - BATHROOM - NIGHT (SMALL PANEL)

Extreme close up - Mr. Fall's brush; he's holding it in his hand. The display has an image of his new cool motorcycle.

PAGE 10/11 (DOUBLE SPLASH)

EXT. URBAN STREETS - THE BIRTHPLACE - NIGHT

Joy is on her motorcycle (headed toward us).

She has the baby in a body sling in front of her (baby is facing Joy). Joy is turned behind her, returning gun fire as Mr. Fall chases her on his own motorcycle, shooting at them. One of his bullets has connected with Joy's all-important wrist band, it goes flying.

Mr. Fall's motorcycle should be futuristic-looking, but more of a badass Harley style. Have a small passenger seat on it, as he will have a passenger later in this issue.

These two pages should be extremely immersive/dynamic.

Note: Add in SFX as you see fit.

CAPTION

... On her ass.

PAGE 12 (SINGLE SPLASH)**1. EXT. BRIDGE - THE BIRTHPLACE - NIGHT**

Bird's eye angle, wide shot - The chase is continuing. Joy has a good lead on Mr. Fall.

PAGE 13 (FIVE PANELS)**1. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT**

Wide shot - A more desolate part of the city. Mostly alleys and empty streets. Degrading train tracks above.

Joy rides down the street. She is passing by a cigarette ad (street level) on a building wall. The ad reads "Cigarettes to Die For"

2. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Still on her bike, Joy is met with a humongous pile of garbage. She can't get through.

JOY
Shit. A dead end.

3. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

The cigarette ad is now slid open, it is actually a door leading inside of a building. All Joy/we can see is darkness beyond the door.

Two VOICES are coming from the darkness.

VOICE 1
This way...

VOICE 2
Hurry.

4. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Joy rides through the entrance and inside the building.

5. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is sitting on his bike, searching. Little does he know that Joy is just beyond the nearby cigarette ad, door now closed.

MR. FALL

Fuck.

PAGE 14 (FOUR PANELS)

1. EXT. ROOFTOP (IN THE BIRTHPLACE) - NIGHT

Medium shot - EARL, Ava's boyfriend from issue #1 is standing on the ledge of a building rooftop (about 4 stories tall). His back is to us, we don't see his face yet. He is holding a six pack of beer in one hand. And he's wearing a black leather jacket/jeans/tee shirt.

CAPTION

A few hours earlier in The Birthplace...

2. EXT. ROOFTOP - NIGHT

Close up - Earl's face. Sweating. Distressed.

CAPTION

Earl, Ava's boyfriend, contemplates ending his life. Not yet committed to the real world consequences, perhaps this is a dry run.

3. EXT. ROOFTOP - NIGHT

Bird's eye (right above Earl's head) - His arms are stretched wide like an eagle, he is looking up toward us, he is on the verge of leaping to his virtual death. Green microchip is clearly visible in his left wrist.

We can also see the streets below... where there's a glimpse/silhouette of a man walking, carrying a grocery bag. His face can't be made out from here --

4. EXT. ROOFTOP - NIGHT

Medium shot of Earl ONLY, kneeling for a better look at the man below. He is totally dumbfounded.

PAGE 15 (THREE PANELS)**1. EXT. STREET LEVEL - NIGHT**

Earl is sneaking up behind the man as he approaches his vintage sports car (convertible).

2. EXT. STREET LEVEL - NIGHT

Close up of man as Earl is collaring him against the wall. Turns out... **the man is an identical version of Earl.** Except he's clean shaven and dressed in French chic attire complete with neck scarf. He's refined, debonair, a gentleman.

Note: For the sake of clarification we'll refer to this man as PROGRAM EARL.

EARL (O.S.)
What the hell?

3. EXT. STREET LEVEL - NIGHT

New angle (two-shot).

EARL
Who are you?

PROGRAM EARL
Name's Earl.

EARL
I'm Earl.

PROGRAM EARL
Well then, the pleasure is mine...
and yours.

PAGE 16 (FOUR PANELS)**1. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT**

Wide angle - Spacious, one floor, high ceilings, a narrow staircase leads to a small loft area where a telescope is pointed out the window.

As for the TV area, it is nearly identical to Ava and Earl's uptown apartment in the real world (ref. issue #1 page 6 panel 2) except there is nothing out of place, it is pristine. The entire dwelling is clean with plenty of room.

Instead of the same window view in issue one, let's make it an abstract painting of a city scape.

The sports car is parked inside this living quarters.

Program Earl is at the kitchen island taking a bouquet of flowers out of the grocery bag.

Earl is standing at the TV area looking around.

EARL
Looks just like my apartment.
You're a program. Ava created you
in my image.

2. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Medium angle of Program Earl. He is smirking.

PROGRAM EARL
I can think of a few differences.

3. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Program Earl is sitting on the couch in the TV area arranging the flowers in a vase on the glass coffee table.

Earl is standing nearby, facing him.

PROGRAM EARL
One can't be certain, but maybe she
created me in the image she wanted
you to be.

EARL
Go to hell.

PROGRAM EARL
Good chance you'll beat me there. I
saw you on the rooftop. Care to
talk about it?

4. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Extreme close up, Earl looking defeated.

PAGE 17 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Earl is walking up the loft staircase toward the telescope. Program Earl is in the background below, still arranging the flowers.

EARL
You some sort of Peeping Tom?

PROGRAM EARL
Bird watcher.

EARL
No birds in this world...

2. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Earl is looking through the telescope. A surprised look on his face.

EARL
Miracles on the other hand --

3. TELESCOPE POV - NIGHT

At a distance, Joy on her motorcycle being chased by Mr. Fall across a bridge. (This is a moment from the earlier chase).

4. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

That same "Cigarettes to Die For" door is open. Joy is riding her motorcycle toward us and into Program Earl's warehouse apartment.

Earl and Program Earl are standing on either side of the door ushering Joy in.

PROGRAM EARL
This way.

EARL
Hurry.

5. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Close up, Joy ONLY - She is taking off her helmet as the flower vase is shattered on the side of her face. A VIOLENT BLOW. We don't see Earl doing this, just his forceful hand driving it into her head.

JOY
Appreciate the help...

PAGE 18 (FIVE PANELS)

1. EXT. BAR - THE BIRTHPLACE - NIGHT

Establishing shot. A hole-in-the wall. The sign on the awning reads: "The Drag & Drop"

Mr. Fall's motorcycle is parked in front.

2. INT. BAR - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is sitting at the bar drowning his sorrows in a glass of liquor. An overweight BARTENDER is behind the bar wiping glasses.

There are only a few other patrons here. A PROSTITUTE (21 years old) is sitting two stools down from Mr. Fall. Her face is prematurely aged, like she's been smoking cigarettes for four decades.

CAPTION

Mr. Fall wanted answers... he needed answers, but no one in The Birthplace could give him any.

PROSTITUTE

You look like you need some company.

MR. FALL

Wrong.

3. INT. BAR - NIGHT

The Prostitute is now standing next to him.

PROSTITUTE

Well, maybe I need some company.

MR. FALL

I'm sure you're quite the catch, but I'm not interested.

4. INT. BAR - NIGHT

The Prostitute is talking directly into his ear, desperate.

PROSTITUTE

I'm no longer having fun here.
Doesn't look like you are either.
Let's cut our losses and get back
to the real world.

CAPTION

Mr. Fall gives it some thought.
There were three ways out of The
Birthplace. Complete the mission,
die, or indulge in a more enjoyable
option...

5. EXT. BAR - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is riding off on his motorcycle with the Prostitute seated in front of him, facing him, straddling her legs around him.

PAGE 19 (SIX PANELS)**1. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT**

Medium shot, Earl is standing, spraying a can of beer AT US (Joy) - a callback from issue #1. Earl is holding the baby with his other arm/hand.

2. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Wide shot, Joy is tied up in a chair in the corner of the room. Arms bound behind her, feet tied to the chair legs (zip-tied). She is not gagged. She is just regaining consciousness. Her knives and swords on the floor across the room.

Earl has Joy's gun in his front waistband. Now, tossing the beer can to the floor, done with it.

Program Earl is standing near his car, confused, watching the assault.

JOY

Please, don't hurt the child.

EARL

Ava drained my entire bank account
right under my nose. I read her
journal. She said she hid it.

JOY
Who the hell is Ava?

EARL
Where's my money!

JOY
I don't know.

3. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Earl backslaps Joy in the face.

4. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Program Earl is grabbing Earl's arm trying to stop him.

PROGRAM EARL
That's no way to treat a lady.

5. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

With one hand, Earl is shoving Program Earl into a glass shelf, shattering it.

6. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Close up, Joy and Earl are face to face. Joy is exhausted, and beat up pretty bad.

(Reminder, Joy's blood and Program Earl's blood should be BLUE).

EARL
Have something to tell me now?

JOY
Yes. I like the other you better.

PAGE 20 (TWO PANELS) BLACK/WHITE

1. EXT. CABIN IN WOODED AREA (REAL WORLD LONDON) - NIGHT

Single story rundown log cabin in a lush wooded area. A dark sedan, Two police motorcycles (with saddle bags), and Mr. Fall's car, are parked out front.

CAPTION
London, England. Real world.

2. INT. CABIN - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is laying on a bed, having just woken up. He is hooked to an IV machine (tube going into his wrist near the embedded chip site). This is keeping his body nourished while in The Birthplace. He is dressed in his usual attire.

PAGE 21 (FIVE PANELS) BLACK/WHITE

1. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Close-up - Mr. Fall is ramming a Government Cop's head into the wall... hard. (These are same cops from issue 1)

2. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Close-up - Mr. Fall kicking the other Cop square in the face.

3. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Wide shot - Mr. Fall is collaring the Government Official, pinning him against the wall. There's a briefcase on the table next to them with "**Classified**" written on it.

We can see the entire room now, including the two unconscious Officers. Lots of take-out food containers around, they've been here for at least a few days.

MR. FALL
The midwife... who is she?

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
Your former sweetheart, Ava, created her. Even included some of her mental complexities. Maybe a few dark secrets.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL (CONT'D)
Wouldn't be surprised if she weaved some of your ways into her. A quasi offspring perhaps?

4. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Close-up of Mr. Fall. He is not buying it.

MR. FALL
Bullshit!

5. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Medium shot - just Mr. Fall and Government Official.

MR. FALL
You were protecting her. Something
about a system volume file. Why?

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
Ava must have programmed that bogus
alert. We're not a compassionate
bunch. We couldn't care less if Joy
died.

PAGE 22 (THREE PANELS) BLACK/WHITE

1. EXT. CABIN - NIGHT

Pissed, Mr. Fall is pulling away in his car. The Government
Official is in the cabin doorway, yelling...

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
We need the encryption code hosts
destroyed! -- Congratulations, you
just got yourself the death
penalty!

2. INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - PARKED - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is in his car looking at the contents inside of a
classified briefcase he stole from Government Official.

Outside the car window we can see trees, otherwise it's a
pretty nondescript location - to be revealed later.

3. INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - PARKED - NIGHT

Close-up on the briefcase contents:

1. Portable computer terminal
2. Floating carousel of images: Mr. Fall, Joy, Ava, and a
building identified by the words "Safe Partition"
3. Small envelope

PAGE 23 (FOUR PANELS) COLOR**1. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT**

Joy is still tied to the chair. Earl is standing over her, baby in one arm, gun in the other (He is not pointing it at her at this time).

Program Earl is still on the floor recovering from Earl's previous assault.

CAPTION
The Birthplace.

EARL
That money means everything to me.

PROGRAM EARL
Money earned or money inherited
from a wealthy relative?

EARL
That doesn't matter, it's mine.

2. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Medium shot, Joy ONLY.

JOY
It's buried.

EARL (OUT OF FRAME)
Liar.

3. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Three shot, Joy and Earl/baby. Earl is nervous, gun visibly trembling in his hand.

JOY
Untie me, and we'll forget this
ever happened. You don't seem like
the killing type.

EARL
Yesterday... I wasn't.

JOY
What about the baby?

EARL
I'll figure something out.

4. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Close up, Earl looking sad. On the verge of tears.

EARL
Before I do this, I need to know.
Did Ava mean all those things she
said about me in her journal?

PAGE 24 (TWO PANELS)

1. INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - PARKED - NIGHT (BLACK AND WHITE)

Mr. Fall is holding the envelope. Written on it is:
"Birthplace Microchips, Emergency Access"

CAPTION
Real World.

2. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT (COLOR)

Close up. Gun to Joy's forehead. Her eyes are closed,
preparing for the end.

CAPTION
The Birthplace.

CHAPTER 4

PAGE 3 (FIVE PANELS) BLACK/WHITE

1. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Charlotte is exiting a "Maintenance" closet. In the b.g. in
the closet, we can see an ORDERLY zipping his pants. They
just finished having sex. Charlotte has a big smile on her
face, despite her missing teeth (knocked out by Ava in issue
2).

CAPTION
London, England. The Year 2052.

CAPTION (CONT'D)
A Better You Psychiatric Hospital

2. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - AVA'S RM. - NIGHT

A small quarters. Bed, toilette, sink, night stand. Her glass door leading to the hallway is closed but has a slot to pass items through.

Medium shot. Ava is on her knees at the toilette with her fingers down her throat - she has just forced herself to vomit. We can see her vomit spewing out and into the toilette.

AVA
(thought bubble)
To hell with this medication.

3. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - AVA'S RM. - NIGHT

Wide shot - Charlotte is in the hallway outside Ava's room, knocking on the door window. Ava is walking over to her.

4. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - AVA'S RM. - NIGHT

Extreme close-up - Charlotte is passing Ava an ID badge (stolen from the Orderly) through the door slot.

CHARLOTTE
Friends?

5. INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL - AVA'S RM. - NIGHT

Close-up of Ava's face looking vindictive as she turns away from Charlotte.

AVA
Best.

PAGE 4 (SINGLE SPLASH) COLOR UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE

1. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NEAR ROADBLOCK - NIGHT

Mr. Fall in the middle of the street, searching for any clue to Joy's whereabouts. His motorcycle is parked nearby.

Note: Please refer to environment description from previous issue.

CAPTION

Mr. Fall returned to The Birthplace
by using an "Emergency Access
Microchip." Retraced his steps.
Searching for Joy. So far...
nothing.

MR. FALL

This is a waste of time.

PAGE 5 (THREE PANELS)

1. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is getting back onto his motorcycle when he hears...

SFX

BANG!

Coming from inside the warehouse.

2. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is quickly grabbing a crowbar from the roadblock
rubbish.

3. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is jamming a crowbar into the warehouse garage door
trying to pry it open.

PAGE 6 (SIX PANELS)

1. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Earl is still holding the baby while standing over Program
Earl having just shot him dead (gun still smoking). Blue
blood seeping from Program Earl's chest.

The baby is crying. LOUD ONOMATOPOEIA.

EARL

(to Program Earl)

First things first.

2. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Earl is setting the baby on the floor, yelling in the baby's face -- as Joy awaits her turn.

EARL
(to baby)
Shut up!

JOY
I get the feeling that money's not
all she took from you.

3. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

As Earl is pointing the gun at Joy, Mr. Fall grabs him from behind --

4. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is body slamming the fuck outta Earl. Joy's gun has fallen on the floor.

5. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is snapping Joy's arm restraints.

6. INT. PROGRAM EARL'S WAREHOUSE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Joy is picking up her gun. Earl is on the floor watching, scared. He knows what's coming.

NOTE: Only want to see Joy's hand picking up gun in foreground with Earl in the background.

PAGE 7 (THREE PANELS)**1. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT**

Joy and Mr. Fall are exiting the garage door.

Joy has the baby back in a body sling in front of her. Joy is walking her motorcycle out of the warehouse.

Mr. Fall is in front of Joy with his back to her.

2. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Joy is pointing the gun at Mr. Fall. They are now facing each other. It's a one-sided standoff. Mr. Fall doesn't look worried.

MR. FALL
Might want to adjust your aim. Your
shot pulls to the left.

MR. FALL (CONT'D)
Back in the alley, that's why you
popped me in the shoulder at point
blank range. Never could break that
habit.

3. EXT. UNDERGROUND STREETS/VIADUCT - NIGHT

Close-up of Joy looking confused. She is looking directly at reader/Mr. Fall. Gun muzzle in frame.

JOY
'Hell are you talking about?

MR. FALL
(out of frame)
Seems we have someone in common.

JOY
Ava.

PAGE 8 (THREE PANELS)

1. EXT. D+'S HOUSE - FRONT YARD - NIGHT

Wide/establishing. Joy, D+ are standing by Joy's red vehicle, loading babies into the trailer. Please remember we've added one baby to the baby count.

Mr. Fall is sitting on the porch steps watching Joy and D+.

Mr. Fall's motorcycle is parked nearby.

2. EXT. D+'S HOUSE - FRONT YARD - NIGHT

Joy is talking to D+. Mr. Fall can be seen in the background.

JOY

... I've no other choice, I must go. Who knows how many more maniacs are out to harm my children.

D+

Can you trust this fellow?

JOY

While his claims are borderline preposterous, whatever redemption tour he's on may work to our advantage...

3. EXT. D+'S HOUSE - FRONT YARD - NIGHT

Close up, Mr. Fall staring at Joy and D+. He is brushing the back of his hair. What's on his mind is anyone's guess.

JOY

(out of frame)

But rest assured, if he has a change of heart, I'll put a hole in it.

PAGE 9 (TWO PANELS)

1. EXT. D+'S HOUSE - FRONT YARD - NIGHT

Joy is giving D+ a fist bump. Happy moment between the two of them. Mr. Fall is not seen in this panel.

JOY

Thank you. From now on I'm going to call you, A+.

D+

I'll settle for a solid C.

2. EXT. DOWNTOWN STREETS - NIGHT

Joy is driving her car down the street (babies in trailer). Mr. Fall is riding his motorcycle beside her. Looks like they're a team now.

PAGE 10 (TWO PANELS)

1. INT. BIRTHPLACE MEMBER SERVICES BLDG. - NIGHT

The Government Official is waking up in a plush hammock, legs crossed, comfortable. We do not want to know where he is yet as it will be revealed in next panel, so no room details at this point.

Note: Please make visible the green microchip on his left wrist - similar to when Mr. Fall entered The Birthplace.

2. INT. BIRTHPLACE MEMBER SERVICES BLDG. - NIGHT

Wide angle, Government Official is walking across the room. Now we realize he's in Member Services with the nasty pallets everyone else shows up on, the sex holograms on the walls (see issue 1, page 19 panel 2).

And let's have the Government Official's suit jacket be unbuttoned - will make sense shortly.

PAGE 11 (FOUR PANELS)

1. EXT. MEMBER SERVICES BLDG. - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of Government Official buttoning his suit jacket. Turns out his button is how he downloads programs much like Mr. Fall's brush and the wrist watch Joy once had.

So, a noticeable glow to his button can highlight this.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
(out of frame)
Download droid soldiers.

2. EXT. MEMBER SERVICES BLDG. - NIGHT

The Government Official is standing, looking toward us, confident. A half-dozen futuristic ANDROID SOLDIERS are standing behind him. A couple of them are still digitally forming. They come equipped with guns, menacing looking, but not indestructible, so, no heavy armor in head and chest area.

Let's make them look different than other soldiers/law enforcement we've seen in real world London.

3. EXT. MEMBER SERVICES BLDG. - NIGHT

The Government Official and Android Soldiers are pulling away in two blacked-out vans.

One of the vehicles splashes a puddle of water all over Mia (walking; on her way to work at the Member Services BLDG.)

4. EXT. MEMBER SERVICES BLDG. - NIGHT

Close-up of Mia, drenched and pissed, looking toward vehicles pulling away.

MIA
Asshole.

PAGE 12 (TWO PANELS)

1. INT. D+'S HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Wide shot, D+ is dusting his book shelf.

2. INT. D+'S HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Medium shot, D+ is returning a book to the shelf. As he does, we can see the Government Official and Soldiers standing nearby, unbeknownst to D+.

PAGE 13 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. D+'S HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Two Soldiers are holding D+ in a chair against his will (heavy hands on his shoulders). Government Official is sitting directly across from him. The soldering gun rests on a table beside the Government Official.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
This is all your doing.

D+
I don't understand.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
The person in which you were modeled after in the real world fostered the program's creator when she was a child.
(MORE)

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL (CONT'D)

You honed her extraordinary
intelligence, but chose to ignore
other intangibles.

2. INT. D+'S HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Medium shot of just Government Official, he is holding one of D+'s books in one hand and the soldering gun in the other, burning the book (a corner of the book is already melted away).

The title of the book: "Basics of Mathematics"

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL

Where's the midwife and children?

3. INT. D+'S HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Close-up of D+. He is in agony because of the book.

D+

Please... don't! It's the first
book my parents gave me.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL

(out of frame)

Where's the midwife and children?

D+

The big guy told her about a place
they could be safe. I think he
called it... The Partition.

CAPTION

The Partition: A safe haven within
The Birthplace. Any program housed
inside of it can not be touched.
With no access himself, the
Government Official knew if the
babies made it there... game over.

4. INT. D+'S HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Government Official is now walking away from D+.

One of the Soldiers is holding a gun to D+'s head as he is
still seated in the chair. Don't want to see the act of
murder here.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL

Delete him.

5. INT. D+'S HOUSE - LIVING RM. - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of the charred math book on the table, only now it has D+'s splattered blood on the cover.

Note: Blood should be color BLUE.

SFX
(gunshot; out of frame)
BANG.

PAGE 14 (SEVEN PANELS)

1. EXT. HOSPITAL - FRONT - NIGHT

A four-story hospital on its last leg, dilapidated, crumbling, HAUNTING. 20th century style.

The sign on the building should read: "New Water Area Hospital"

Wide over-the-shoulder angle of Joy and Mr. Fall standing together, staring at the hospital in wonderment. Neither have a weapon drawn.

MR. FALL
You've got to be shitting me. This
is where she put the Partition?

2. EXT. HOSPITAL - FRONT - NIGHT

This panel should closely mimic framing of issue #3 panel 5.

Two obscure Assailants are standing in front of the door, blocking access. One of the assailants is holding a knife.

Joy is approaching, pushing a hovering stroller with the remaining children. Mr. Fall is pulling up the rear behind her.

3. EXT. HOSPITAL - FRONT - NIGHT

Close-up of Mr. Fall. Emotional, pain in his eyes.

CAPTION
Mr. Fall had a gut-wrenching
feeling. Is this how the loves of
his life were snatched from him
years ago?

ASSAILANT 1
(out of frame)
Give us your valuables!

ASSAILANT 2
(out of frame)
We won't ask twice!

4. EXT. HOSPITAL - FRONT - NIGHT

Close-up, Mr. Fall is clutching the knife blade right before the Assailant is able to jab it into Joy's belly.

5. EXT. HOSPITAL - FRONT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is forcing the knife into that same Assailant's throat with the Assailant still gripping the weapon.

Note: Assailants blood is the color BLUE.

6. EXT. HOSPITAL - FRONT - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is snapping the other Assailant's neck.

SFX
Crack!

7. EXT. HOSPITAL - FRONT - NIGHT

Joy is addressing Mr. Fall.

JOY
I had it under control. Don't
expect a thank you.

PAGE 15 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy, and the babies (still in stroller) are standing in front of a highly fortified door. Joy is pushing on the door to no avail. Mr. Fall is with her, holding his brush.

This door should have a futuristic flair, and should look out of place in this late 20th century structure.

The sign on the door reads: "NEONATAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT"

There is a vending machine against the wall by the door (to be used later). No other people are in sight.

JOY
Motherfucker! It won't open.

MR. FALL
I can download assistance.

2. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Close-up, Mr. Fall is sticking an explosive on the door. Digital artifacts around the bomb.

3. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy, Mr. Fall, and the babies are cornering a wall, taking cover a little further down from the NICU door.

The device is exploding behind them. It is a massive display of smoke and fire.

4. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy, Mr. Fall, and the babies are back in front of the door. The smoke has cleared. There's not a scratch on the door, it's still closed shut.

JOY
Dammit!

5. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy is kneeling down, addressing the babies.

JOY
I'm sorry. I wasn't enough.

AVA
(out of frame)
Not now, but you were.

PAGE 16 (SINGLE SPLASH)

INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Ava is standing in front of them. She is wearing same clothing she wore in the Psyche hospital.

Joy is taken aback. Mr. Fall shows a small smile.

MR. FALL

Ava.

AVA

Hello, Willard. It's been a while.

PAGE 17 (TWO PANELS)

1. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy is collaring Ava, has her pinned to the floor.

JOY

You're the bitch that did all this?

AVA

I played a role. But so have you.

2. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is looking at the display on his brush. On the display, an image of Mia with text that reads: "Watch Your Back"

Note: Image on brush should have same feel as issue 1, page 25, panel 3.

PAGE 18 (FIVE PANELS)

1. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

The Droid Soldiers are cornering a wall at opposite end of hallway, shooting toward Mr. Fall, Joy, Ava, babies. Bullets are missing them.

Joy is still collaring Ava on the floor. These two are ignoring the attack, they've got some things to work out.

2. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Intense action sequence coming up.

Primary focus in this panel should be on Joy and Ava still on the floor under discussion. Nearby, Mr. Fall is pulling/knocking down the vending machine for cover from bullets.

Note: Here's the environment layout: (1)Government Official covering his ears as his Soldiers are shooting. (2)The pulled down vending machine for cover. (3)Mr. Fall right behind vending machine. (4)NICU door, babies, Joy and Ava.

AVA

The doubts, confusion, fear you once had... that's what made you a badass, that's what the hell you should be riding for...

AVA (CONT'D)

The U.P. you took changed that, making your actions... fraudulent.

3. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Mr. Fall is crouched behind the vending machine with a automatic style handgun, shooting down the hall at the Droid Soldiers, he has already destroyed three of them. **Joy, Ava, babies are not in this panel.**

*Perhaps a cool visual here: The gun Mr. Fall is using is still digitally forming, but the bullets are still coming out, and even they are still forming as they exit his muzzle and float through the air.

4. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy is still collaring Ava on the floor. Ava is crying. - **Just the two of them in this panel;** emotional climax. Bullets pinging off the wall above their heads.

JOY

Without that injection, I would have failed them.

AVA

At least you would've tried. And that's better than what I did. You were supposed to be better than me.

5. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Government Official is hiding behind/cornering a wall, unsure what to do. All of his Droid Soldiers are dead near him (mangled electronics visible). A Droid Soldier's gun is on the floor close by him, although he is not eyeing it right now.

PAGE 19 (FIVE PANELS)**1. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT**

The shooting has stopped. Ava and Joy still conversing on the floor. Mr. Fall is sitting on the floor against the vending machine (tired after the shootout), watching Ava and Joy. Babies should be included here, still in the stroller.

JOY
Open the door!

AVA
Only you can do that...

2. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Close-up of Ava holding a Syringe (U.P.).

AVA
The real you. This will revert you
back to default setting.

JOY
(out of frame)
If you can do that, why can't you
make The Birthplace like it was?

AVA
I have other plans for this place.

3. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy jabs the syringe into her arm. She is smiling.

CAPTION
The injection came with no
discomfort, and even rendered a
smile from Joy. Something she
hasn't done in a long time. The
midwife she was meant to be.

4. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of the syringe in Joy's hand, the syringe casing is now neatly split open. Inside of the opening is a glowing door key.

5. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Joy inserts the key into the NICU/Partition door lock.

PAGE 20 (SINGLE SPLASH)**INT. HOSPITAL - NICU/PARTITION - NIGHT**

Angle should be from inside the NICU/Partition.

Joy is looking at us/the reader -- standing in front of the now open NICU door. She is in awe at what she sees. Joy has the babies in the stroller in front of her, preparing to enter.

Ava and Mr. Fall are standing on either side of her, but behind her, looking into the Partition as well.

Ambient colors/lighting from inside the room should be spilling onto Joy and babies (Majestic in nature).

Note: We never see what is inside the NICU/Partition.

AVA

Not everyone gets a moment like
this. Don't take it for granted.

PAGE 21 (FIVE PANELS)**1. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT**

Surprise! The angry Government Official is pointing a gun at Joy's back as she's about to leave.

2. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of Ava.

AVA

No!

3. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Extreme close-up of Mr. Fall.

MR. FALL

No!

4. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Mr. Fall and Ava are facing each other, blocking Joy from being killed. In doing so, they are catching two bullets -- bullets go through Mr. Fall's back, out, and into Ava's chest.

Friendly reminder: Blood should be color red.

5. INT. HOSPITAL - HALLWAY - NIGHT

Government Official is pissed, kicking on the closed Partition door, he's too late. Joy and babies have escaped.

Ava and Mr. Fall are dead on the floor.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
You can't do this! I must reset the
system!

PAGE 22 (FIVE PANELS) (BLACK AND WHITE)

1. EXT. CEMETERY - NIGHT

Mr. Fall's car is parked amongst a field of headstones. Let's draw attention to one of the headstones. Maybe it's bigger in the foreground, however it should be back side of headstone, **we don't want to see the writing on it.**

A shovel is leaned against a tree somewhere in the panel. Should not be a focus, just subtly placed.

2. INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - NIGHT

Ava and Mr. Fall are waking up. Ava in passenger seat.

The briefcase Mr. Fall stole from Government Official is on the dashboard counter.

3. INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - NIGHT

New angle of Joy and Mr. Fall. Feel free to use your genius with switching up angles. Through car window could be an option.

We can see the briefcase in this panel.

MR. FALL
You came to visit her too?

AVA
Uhh... yes. Then I saw you. Used a
chip from the briefcase to join you
in The Birthplace.

MR. FALL
I'm happy you did.

4. INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - NIGHT

Ava's hand is caressing the back of Mr. Fall's head. Mr. Fall
is loving it.

MR. FALL
The back of my head...that's the
last place you touched me.

AVA
I remember.

5. INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - NIGHT

Ava is typing on the briefcase computer terminal.

We do not see what she is typing.

Mr. Fall is looking on.

MR. FALL
What are you doing?

AVA
Just a little tech support.

PAGE 23 (FOUR PANELS) (COLOR)

1. EXT. URBAN STREETS - THE BIRTHPLACE - NIGHT

Government Official is standing among the urban decay,
dejected.

He is touching his suit jacket button to activate it.

GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL
Initiate advanced protocol. Exit
program.

2. EXT. URBAN STREETS - THE BIRTHPLACE - NIGHT

Extreme close-up on his suit jacket button. It reads: "ERROR"

3. EXT. URBAN STREETS - THE BIRTHPLACE - NIGHT

Angle from behind Government Official - there are multiple digital billboards (think New York Times Square but not in as good a shape) that read: "Not everything will work to perfection"

4. EXT. URBAN STREETS - THE BIRTHPLACE - NIGHT

Government Official is now flat on the ground, DEAD, red blood seeping from his mouth.

PAGE 24 (THREE PANELS) (BLACK AND WHITE)

1. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Mr. Fall and Ava standing over Government Official as he's seated in a chair, hunched back, DEAD, with a bullet to his forehead. A fairly gruesome sight.

Mr. Fall is pointing a handgun at Government Official's forehead, gun still smoking. Ava is just a willing witness here.

Government Official is hooked to IV machines (tubes going into his wrist near the embedded chip site, just like Mr. Fall was in cabin when he woke up).

Note: Would like stay more focused on the violent act and reveal more of the room in the next panel.

The room is in same disarray it was before with lots of take-out food containers, and the two unconscious Officers.

2. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Ava and Mr. Fall are standing in the middle of the room, face to face, holding hands, rekindling a relationship?

MR. FALL

Does this mean we're going to give us another try?

AVA
 Sorry. I'm not ready. Maybe one day
 I will be.

3. INT. CABIN - LIVING AREA - NIGHT

Ava is walking out of cabin away from Mr. Fall.
 Mr. Fall is watching her leave. Sad. Out of his life again.

PAGE 25 (FIVE PANELS) (BLACK AND WHITE)

1. EXT. CEMETERY - NIGHT

IT'S RAINING. With a shovel, Ava is digging at the foot of the marker.

She has a lollipop in her mouth.

The briefcase is on the ground beside her and a stolen cop motorcycle is parked nearby.

2. EXT. CEMETERY - NIGHT

Ava is pulling out a duffle bag from the dirt. It was buried.

3. EXT. CEMETERY - NIGHT

Bird's eye angle. Ava is looking in the open duffle bag, a shit ton of money inside of it. --

From this same angle we catch a glimpse of the disrupted grave site with a peek of a small casket inside (her and Mr. Fall's deceased child. A disturbing sight).

This panel's framing should look similar to Earl's panel when he contemplated jumping off the building (Issue #3, Page 14 panel 3).

CAPTION
 This is the real reason Ava came to
 visit her daughter's gravesite. It
 wasn't to pay her respects at
 all...

4. EXT. CEMETERY - NIGHT

Over-the-shoulder, Ava is kneeling and with a rock, she is drawing a heart around the name on the headstone, "Different"

Please include the quotation marks around the word.
 "Different" is what she named her lost baby per issue 3.

CAPTION

... But part of her felt obligated.
 And part of her had finally
 embraced her uniqueness.

5. EXT. CEMETERY - NIGHT

Grave POV, Ava is standing over the grave, refilling the hole with dirt - Dirt is falling on us/the reader.

PAGE 26 (SINGLE SPLASH) (BLACK AND WHITE)

INT. MR. FALL'S CAR - NIGHT

From a distance, Mr. Fall is watching Ava pull away on the motorcycle.

MR. FALL

What are you planning, love?

THE END.